



Symmetry is simple yet elegant

split into nine equal parts by two horizontal and vertical lines. According to the rule of thirds, you should always try to place the subject along these lines or where they intersect, instead of right in the middle. The reason for this is that an image where the subject is placed one thirds into the frame looks more pleasing than one where the subject is right in the middle.

Let's say you're shooting a portrait of a person or, say, a lamp post on the street. Instead of having the subject right in the middle, align it alongside one of the vertical lines one thirds or two thirds into the frame and the shot will turn out to be a lot more interesting.

Similarly, when you are shooting something such as a sunset, try and align the horizon along one of the horizontal lines and the effect would be lot more pleasing than splitting the frame in half. Depending upon whether you want to focus more on the water or the sky, you should align the horizon on the upper third or lower third line, respectively. If you are dealing with a small object, it makes sense to place it along one of the four points where the grid lines would meet, ideally the lower two.

The rule of thirds is not a hard and fast rule and as is often the case with photography you are encouraged to experiment. It is, however, a tried and tested rule and in most cases gives the best results.

Another style of composition is symmetry. This works particularly well for 1:1 aspect ratio or square shots typically used for Instagram. As you can